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FIRST NEWS

Pre-Market Institutional Equity Research

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ACTIONABLE HIGHLIGHTS · THE CALL

PSEi edged **+0.17% to 6,116.53 (+10.54)** — a third straight green close on **negative breadth (88 advancers vs. 106 decliners)**. Net foreign was **+₱219M**, but **ICT alone was +₱627.9M** — strip it out and foreigners sold ~₱409M, led by a brutal **AC −₱295M**. The index is being propped by one name while the Ayala/SM heavyweights are distributed.

ACCUMULATE — METALS & THE DEFENSIVE-DIVIDEND BID

- **AT (Atlas Mining) —** Consolidated −1.5% to ₱22.70 after Monday's spike, but foreign kept buying +₱37.0M (2nd straight day); ₱267M turnover. The Dominion / Tampakan re-rating holds — accumulate on dips into the 14 Sep DHI vote. Target ₱50.
- **BDO & MER —** Foreign flow rotated into defensive yield: BDO flipped to +₱80.5M (from −₱52M), MER +₱38.2M, alongside MYNLD/MWC. This is the barbell's resilient-dividend leg — buy quality yield selectively.
- **APX / IMI —** APX +4.2% to ₱17.50 (+₱26.1M foreign) as gold recovers to ~$4,437; IMI +2.5% to ₱8.45 on a 3rd up-day (+₱15.7M foreign, AI-hardware/EMS).

MONITOR — ONE-NAME FLOW & SPECIAL SITUATIONS

- **ICT —** Third straight day of enormous, one-directional foreign buying (+₱627.9M) on ₱1.60B turnover (~27% of the whole market). This reads as an index/passive weight change or strategic accumulation, not organic demand — hold, don't chase the print.
- **WEB (PhilWeb) —** Still suspended. Entered a ₱4.23B cross-investment to take 30% of B2B digital-gaming infra firm JKS Tech (Epic Game), funded partly by a ₱1.34B treasury-share sale to JKS. Special situation — await resumption.
- **TEL —** Debt-reduction plan via a data-centre REIT and a Maya boost; enterprise/fiber/B2B the real drivers. Foreign +₱4.4M — constructive, fits the dividend barbell.

CAUTION — ACCELERATING DISTRIBUTION & RISING YIELDS

- **Ayala complex (AC / ALI) —** AC −3.6% on foreign −₱295M (dragging Holding Firms −1.29%); ALI −₱93.8M for a 3rd session. Sustained, accelerating distribution — stand aside until flow stabilises.
- **CNVRG —** Foreign −₱35.5M again; reliability complaints (Pampanga PSE-link outage) and Ookla/ESCAP flagging PHL/Metro-Manila mobile-speed and cost lags. Avoid.
- **Macro / desk view —** PSEi struggling to hold the 6,000–6,150 zone; risk of testing 5,800 if foreign selling accelerates. Yields rising (PHL 7.379%, US 4.842%), Brent >$100, 2026 EPS growth a modest 3–7%.

SESSION DASHBOARD

PSEi Close	6,116.53	+10.54 (+0.17%)
Intraday Range	6,104.85 – 6,143.77	52-wk: 5,584.35 – 6,673.61
Breadth (A / D / U)	88 / 106 / 55	Negative breadth (3rd day) · Traded 249 · Trades 75,868
Total Volume	939.60M shares	Value ₱5.90B
Foreign Buying / Selling	₱3.41B / ₱3.19B	Net +₱219.10M — but ICT +₱627.9M alone
Block Sales	12.14M shares	₱263.61M
USD-PHP	₱62.635 (flat)	DDS ref (prior day) ₱62.625 · peso near ₱62.6

GLOBAL MARKETS

Prior close vs. latest close. Broad risk-off — US extended its losing streak (Dow −405) on rising Treasury yields and oil; Asia mostly lower. PSEi held green but barely.

Index	Prior	Latest	%Chg
Dow Jones	52,786.07	**52,380.66**	-0.77%
S&P 500	7,673.52	**7,636.36**	-0.48%
NASDAQ	26,421.41	**26,253.34**	-0.64%
PSEi (PCOMP)	6,105.99	**6,116.53**	+0.17%
Nikkei 225	65,339.51	**64,756.91**	-0.89%
Shanghai (SHCOMP)	3,940.55	**3,951.51**	+0.28%
Hang Seng	25,317.18	**25,274.96**	-0.17%
KOSPI	7,027.27	**6,984.46**	-0.61%
SENSEX (India)	75,577.58	**74,764.23**	-1.08%
TWSE (Taiwan)	47,105.78	**47,183.36**	+0.16%
ASX 200	8,929.90	**8,785.40**	-1.62%
KLCI (Malaysia)	1,714.40	**1,714.34**	-0.00%
JCI (Indonesia)	6,686.44	**6,678.20**	-0.12%
STI (Singapore)	5,767.45	**5,729.63**	-0.66%
SET50 (Thailand)	1,083.68	**1,083.06**	-0.06%
Vietnam (VN-Index)	1,830.44	**1,827.12**	-0.18%

COMMODITIES

Commodity	Prior	Latest	%Chg
WTI Crude ($/bbl)	94.49	n/a	n/a
Brent Crude ($/bbl)	99.36	**101.38**	+2.03%
Gold COMEX ($/oz)	4,394.60	**4,437.50**	+0.98%
Silver COMEX ($/oz)	66.45	**67.92**	+2.21%
Copper COMEX (¢/lb)	678.90	**685.30**	+0.94%
Nickel ($/MT)	19,004.65	**19,007.20**	+0.01%
Coal ($/MT)	148.65	**147.35**	-0.87%
Corn (¢/bu)	530.75	**527.25**	-0.66%

Commodity	Prior	Latest	%Chg
Wheat (¢/bu)	743.50	**726.75**	**-2.25%**
Cocoa ($/MT)	5,913.00	**5,951.00**	**+0.64%**
Coffee (¢/lb)	291.30	**292.05**	**+0.26%**
Sugar (¢/lb)	19.09	**19.39**	**+1.57%**

WTI's latest source print was unusable (garbled as "6.62"); shown n/a — Brent (+2.0% to $101.38) is the reliable crude reference this session. Gold recovered +0.98% to ~$4,437 and copper +0.94% — the metals/energy complex stayed firm, supporting mining and energy-security names.

FX & RATES

FX / Rate	Prior	Latest	Note
PHL 10-yr Bond (%)	7.351	**7.379**	+2.8 bp · rising, >7% trigger
US 10-yr Bond (%)	4.789	**4.842**	+5.3 bp · driving US selloff
USD-PHP	62.635	**62.635**	flat · near ₱62.6
USD-JPY	153.32	**153.62**	yen softer
USD-CNY	6.7085	**6.7067**	yuan firmer
EUR-USD	1.1631	**1.1632**	flat

PHILIPPINES STRATEGY

Desk view. The index is struggling to hold the 6,000–6,150 consolidation zone, and we see rising risk of a test toward 5,800 if net foreign selling keeps accelerating. Three green closes mask the reality: breadth has been negative all three days and the tape is being carried by a single name (ICT). Rising yields (PHL 10-yr 7.379%, US 4.842%), Brent above $100, and a modest 3–7% 2026 earnings-growth outlook argue for defence over beta.
Where we lean in. We favour the barbell that foreign flow is already running: resilient domestic dividend/utility names (MER, BDO on its flow reversal, the REITs) on one end, and the metals re-rating (AT into the Tampakan catalyst, APX on gold's recovery) on the other. We fade the crowded Ayala/SM distribution (AC, ALI, SM) and telco weakness (CNVRG), and we treat ICT's move as a technical/index flow rather than a signal to chase. Keep dry powder for a 5,800 test.

SECTORAL SUMMARY

Sector	Close	%Chg	Pt.Chg	Value ₱M
Financials	1,898.99	**-0.12%**	(2.37)	1,400.11
Industrial	7,971.93	**+0.05%**	+3.69	749.12
Holding Firms	4,296.19	**-1.29%**	(56.01)	704.57
Property	1,852.40	**-0.82%**	(15.33)	400.83
Services	3,368.21	**+1.59%**	+52.68	1,987.27
Mining & Oil	21,659.77	**+0.55%**	+119.06	656.06
All Shares	3,385.85	**+0.04%**	+1.28	—
PSEi	**6,116.53**	**+0.17%**	+10.54	—

Holding Firms (−1.29%, −56 pts) was the drag, hammered by AC; Services (+1.59%, ICT) and Mining & Oil (+0.55%) again did the lifting.

FOREIGN FUND FLOW

Net foreign **+₱219.10M** is, once more, one name: **ICT +₱627.9M**. Ex-ICT, foreigners were net sellers of ~₱409M — the Ayala/SM heavyweights (AC –₱295M, ALI –₱93.8M, SM –₱82.0M) under accelerating distribution, offset only by rotation into defensive yield (BDO, MER) and metals (AT, APX).

Top Foreign BUY	₱M	Top Foreign SELL	₱M
ICT	+627.91	AC	(295.12)
BDO	+80.47	ALI	(93.81)
MER	+38.24	SM	(82.03)
AT	+37.01	CNVRG	(35.45)
APX	+26.10	SGP	(20.13)
IMI	+15.69	GTCAP	(15.45)
ABG	+14.90	SPNEC	(12.15)
AREIT	+11.66	SMPH	(12.07)
GLO	+9.33	ACEN	(10.61)
BPI	+7.05	URC	(8.57)

MOST ACTIVE BY VALUE

Stock	Close ₱	Value ₱M
ICT	975.00	**1,601.81**
BDO	118.90	**629.62**
BPI	104.00	**473.63**
AC	491.40	**329.84**
AT	22.70	**266.65**
ALI	14.74	**204.05**
SM	554.50	**153.58**
PX	11.50	**121.77**
MBT	64.70	**114.46**
GLO	1,632.00	**103.62**
APX	17.50	**88.24**
IMI	8.45	**84.25**
SGP	24.70	**79.45**
CNVRG	9.08	**79.18**
MER	485.00	**79.09**

ICT's ₱1,601.8M is regular-market and ≈27% of the day's total ₱5.90B turnover — a single name is the market. BDO (₱629.6M) and BPI (₱473.6M) round out heavy, foreign-driven bank turnover.

BLOCK SALES

Stock	Price ₱	Volume	Value ₱
CNPF	32.07	799,500	**25,642,043.70**
BDO	120.00	354,740	**42,568,055.05**
BDO	120.00	500,000	**59,998,850.00**
CNPF	32.03	907,600	**29,066,616.08**
MONDE	6.88	4,599,500	**31,630,301.55**
MWIDE	5.16	4,000,000	**20,640,000.00**
AT	22.54	917,200	**20,674,605.20**
AC	508.81	65,620	**33,388,276.25**
TOTAL		**12,144,160**	**263,608,747.83**

Block-distorted (regular-market value in brackets): MONDE ₱31.6M block (₱4.86M); MWIDE ₱20.6M block (₱4.98M); CNPF ₱54.7M blocks (₱14.26M) — turnover on these is overstated by the crosses.

PSEI-30 CONSTITUENT TRACKER

Reflects the 02 Feb 2026 rebalance (RCR in, AGI out). Net-foreign in ₱; no day-over-day % column (full-roster prior closes not published).

Symbol	Close	High	Low	Net Foreign ₱
AC	**491.40**	510.00	488.60	(295,118,672)
ACEN	**2.58**	2.69	2.57	(10,614,510)
AEV	**36.60**	37.20	36.55	168,015
ALI	**14.74**	15.06	14.74	(93,811,354)
AP	**45.00**	45.60	45.00	3,183,610
BDO	**118.90**	120.10	118.80	80,469,046
BLOOM	**2.29**	2.35	2.28	(6,492,170)
BPI	**104.00**	104.50	102.90	7,046,412
CNPF	**31.70**	32.00	31.50	(7,793,325)
CNVRG	**9.08**	9.16	9.08	(35,450,288)
DMC	**7.97**	8.02	7.86	1,267,227
EMI	**15.30**	15.36	15.26	(2,617,554)
GLO	**1,632.00**	1,645.00	1,590.00	9,326,850
GTCAP	**479.00**	488.00	476.60	(15,448,388)
ICT	**975.00**	984.00	956.00	627,910,240
JFC	**152.90**	153.40	150.50	4,868,011
JGS	**20.05**	20.50	20.05	(287,465)
LTG	**14.98**	15.00	14.94	4,465,040
MBT	**64.70**	64.90	64.40	(9,840,027)
MER	**485.00**	487.80	479.00	38,242,320
MONDE	**6.86**	6.95	6.82	1,056,660
PGOLD	**40.30**	40.80	40.30	(8,335,950)
RCR	**6.75**	6.84	6.75	(4,163,091)

Symbol	Close	High	Low	Net Foreign ₱
SCC	**17.70**	18.14	17.62	1,724,468
SM	**554.50**	558.50	553.00	(82,026,785)
SMC	**61.95**	62.40	61.80	(151,903)
SMPH	**18.10**	18.36	17.94	(12,071,674)
TEL	**1,145.00**	1,145.00	1,131.00	4,386,325
URC	**58.70**	58.95	58.50	(8,569,854)
WLCON	**5.69**	5.80	5.66	(686,302)

CORPORATE STANCE CARDS

ICT · A third day as the market — foreign buying +₱627.9M

ICT closed ₱975 (up again) on ₱1,601.8M of regular-market turnover — roughly 27% of the entire ₱5.90B market — with net foreign buying of +₱627.9M that by itself flipped the whole market to net-buyer status for the third straight session. Cumulatively, foreigners have bought well over ₱1B of ICT this week alone, on the Manzanillo (Mexico) capacity story.

Analysis. Three consecutive sessions of enormous, one-directional buying of this size in a single name point to an index/passive weight change or a strategic accumulation, not broad organic demand. We remain constructive on the dollar-earner franchise and accumulate on dips, but we will not chase this print — the flow can normalise abruptly once the driver clears, and ICT is now masking heavy distribution elsewhere.

Stance: **ACCUMULATE ON DIPS (DON'T CHASE)**

AC / ALI · Ayala complex under accelerating foreign distribution

Ayala Corp fell −3.6% to ₱491.40 on net foreign selling of −₱295.1M — the single heaviest outflow of the day and the reason Holding Firms dropped −1.29% (−56 pts). Ayala Land added −₱93.8M for a third straight session of selling, closing −1.3% at ₱14.74. On the operating side, AC's BYD distribution reported eight-month sales already surpassing full-year 2025 volume.

Analysis. The operating positives (BYD momentum, ALI's leasing base) are being overwhelmed by sustained, accelerating foreign distribution across the group. We stand aside on the Ayala complex until two-sided flow returns; a stabilisation in AC/ALI outflows is our signal to re-engage the deep-value case, not before.

Stance: **MONITOR · STAND ASIDE**

AT · Atlas consolidates the spike; foreign keeps accumulating

Atlas Mining eased −1.5% to ₱22.70 (after touching ₱24 intraday) on ₱266.7M turnover, digesting Monday's +10.6% jump — but foreign investors bought a further +₱37.0M, a second straight day of accumulation. The Dominion (Sy/Consunji) 20.43% stake and the Tampakan copper-gold merger remain the anchor; DHI shareholders vote on the capital increase and merger on 14 Sep.

Analysis. Foreign accumulation persisting through a price consolidation is the confirmation we want. We keep the accumulate-on-dips stance with a ₱50 reference target, adding into weakness ahead of the 14 Sep vote; copper's firmness (+0.94%) and gold's recovery underpin the trade.

Stance: **ACCUMULATE ON DIPS · TARGET ₱50**

Defensive dividend bid (BDO · MER · REITs) · Foreign flow rotates into resilient yield

The clearest positive rotation of the session: BDO drew +₱80.5M of foreign buying (a sharp reversal from −₱52M the prior day) on ₱629.6M turnover, Meralco +₱38.2M, with supportive flow into MYNLD, MWC, AREIT (+₱11.7M) and MREIT (+₱5.8M). This is the resilient-domestic-dividend leg of the barbell that capital is favouring amid the risk-off backdrop.

Analysis. With yields rising and beta risky, we like selective quality-yield exposure — Meralco and the REITs as cleaner defensives, BDO tactically on its flow reversal (mindful that a 7.379% 10-yr still caps bank re-rating). Own the barbell's defensive end alongside the metals leadership.

Stance: **ACCUMULATE SELECTIVELY**

TEL · PLDT's deleveraging optionality — DC REIT and Maya

PLDT closed ₱1,145 (up) with modest foreign buying of +₱4.4M as the market weighs its debt-reduction plan: a potential data-centre REIT to monetise infrastructure and an uplift from its Maya digital-banking stake, with enterprise, fiber and B2B services the real earnings drivers over a steady consumer core.

Analysis. The DC-REIT monetisation and Maya optionality give TEL a self-help deleveraging path plus a defensive dividend — a good fit for the current barbell. We are constructive and accumulate on weakness, watching for concrete REIT timelines as the catalyst.

Stance: **ACCUMULATE ON WEAKNESS**

WEB (PhilWeb) · A ₱4.23B pivot into B2B digital-gaming infrastructure

Still suspended, PhilWeb has entered a ₱4.23B cross-investment to acquire a 30% strategic stake in JKS Tech Solutions — the unlisted B2B digital-entertainment infrastructure provider behind the Epic Game brand — funding it in part by selling ₱1.34B of treasury shares to JKS (per BusinessWorld).

Analysis. This is a strategic pivot toward B2B gaming-infrastructure rather than an earnings event, and the cross-shareholding aligns the two firms. We treat WEB as a suspended special situation: no directional view until trading resumes and the deal terms, valuation and pro-forma economics are clear.

Stance: **SPECIAL SITUATION · SUSPENDED**

CNVRG · Distribution plus a service-quality overhang

Converge drew −₱35.5M of foreign selling for a second straight session (close ₱9.08), against a backdrop of service-reliability complaints — including a reported inability to reach the PSE online-trading link over Converge in Pampanga while Globe worked — and Ookla/ESCAP data flagging Metro Manila's lagging mobile speed and the country's high broadband cost.

Analysis. Sustained foreign distribution plus a reputational/quality overhang and competitive-pricing scrutiny keep us negative near term. We avoid CNVRG until the outflows abate and there is evidence the service-quality narrative is turning.

Stance: **AVOID**

SMARTWATCH

ABS-CBN (ABS)	Adjusting its capital plan to accommodate new investors, following the ₱6B subscription and the ~27% I&C Holdings stake (BusinessWorld). ABS ₱3.64.
SM	SM Offices signed a Visa expansion lease at Four E-Com — supportive of the premium-office leasing narrative even as SM shares saw −₱82M foreign selling.
RRHI	Robinsons Supermarket opened its first Panglao (Bohol) branch — retail-footprint growth; RRHI remains under tender/suspension at the ₱48.30 level (no board trade).
Energy	SunAsia and Thailand's Gunkul are tying up on a ₱62.5B floating-solar project — a large renewables build supportive of the sector's pipeline.
Aviation / Property	Riyadh Air began Manila flights (read-through to airports AEV/AIC and carriers CEB/PAL). Damosa Land's Anflo estate now hosts 24 operational locators.
V (Vantage)	Doubled its corporate share-buyback programme to ₱600M; V firmed with foreign +₱0.02M. Buybacks also flagged in FRUIT and URC.
Flow watch	Brief SmartWatch names: ACR, IMI, NIKL, APX, PNB, OGP, ICT, MWC, DMC, MER, MREIT, AREIT, BPI, EMI, JFC, MBT. Notable — PNB +₱4.1M, NIKL +₱4.1M, DMC +₱1.3M, EMI −₱2.6M, MBT −₱9.8M.

PSE DIVIDEND YIELD (DIVY 20) TRACKER

Index-level close: N/A (not published in DQR summary tables). Roster provisional pending PSE Edge verification. Close ₱ / net-foreign ₱.

Symbol	Close ₱	Net Foreign ₱
MER	**485.00**	38,242,320
GLO	**1,632.00**	9,326,850
TEL	**1,145.00**	4,386,325
SCC	**17.70**	1,724,468
AP	**45.00**	3,183,610
DMC	**7.97**	1,267,227
PGOLD	**40.30**	(8,335,950)
GTCAP	**479.00**	(15,448,388)
SECB	**64.20**	(2,858,043)
CBC	**53.30**	1,606,519
PNB	**76.65**	4,132,355
MBT	**64.70**	(9,840,027)
BDO	**118.90**	80,469,046
BPI	**104.00**	7,046,412
AREIT	**37.30**	11,662,360
RCR	**6.75**	(4,163,091)
MREIT	**13.90**	5,760,450
FGEN	**26.00**	3,110,510
SMPH	**18.10**	(12,071,674)
COSCO	**7.88**	1,771,778

PSE MIDCAP (MIDCAP 20) TRACKER

Index-level close: N/A (not published in DQR summary tables). Roster provisional pending PSE Edge verification. Close ₱ / net-foreign ₱.

Symbol	Close ₱	Net Foreign ₱
CNPF	31.70	(7,793,325)
MONDE	6.86	1,056,660
WLCON	5.69	(686,302)
EMI	15.30	(2,617,554)
PLUS	9.35	(7,498,220)
BLOOM	2.29	(6,492,170)
GSMI	232.00	(1,620,850)
SEVN	32.00	(464,620)
NIKL	4.75	4,075,340
FNI	2.55	(3,267,410)
CREC	4.88	—
MRSGI	1.10	—
COSCO	7.88	1,771,778
HI	4.99	—
AXLM	2.81	(4,075,700)
DNL	3.49	542,530
CIC	11.14	2,958
PIZZA	5.64	—
MAXS	2.10	—
SGP	24.70	(20,132,235)

DISCLAIMER